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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Pritzker again makes Trump-Nazi comparison

Lambastes threat by president of DC-like takeover in Chicago

By **Jeremy Gorner**
Chicago Tribune

Gov. JB Pritzker on Monday likened President Donald Trump’s call for possible National Guard troops occupying Chicago to when the Nazi Party in Germany “tore down a constitutional republic” in the 1930s.

One day after Pritzker said he wouldn’t rule out a presidential run in 2028, his remarks at a north suburban school district continued his war of words with Trump, who earlier in the day actually elevated Pritzker’s presidential aspirations by saying of Pritzker “maybe he has a chance” even as he insulted the Democratic governor.

Trump brought up Chicago — as well as the major Democratic cities New York and Los Angeles — as he announced he was mobilizing the District of Columbia National Guard to address crime in the nation’s capital, even though the crime rate in the city has fallen in recent years.

“If we need to, we’re going to do the same thing in Chicago, which is a disaster,” Trump said before calling Chicago’s mayor “incompetent” — without naming Mayor Brandon Johnson — and saying the same of Pritzker and then poking fun at the governor’s presidential ambitions.

“And now I understand he wants to be president. But I noticed he lost a little weight, so maybe he has a chance, you know? You never know what happens,” the president said Monday of the governor. “But Pritzker’s a gross incompetent guy.”

Pritzker’s political team didn’t miss a beat, posting on the social media site X, “Donald, thanks for the compliment!” before adding: “Let’s not lie to the public, you and I both know you have no authority to take over Chicago. By the way, where are the Epstein files?” — referring to the

Turn to **Pritzker**, Page 2



FBI and Border Patrol officers arrest a man along the U Street corridor Sunday in Washington, D.C. President Donald Trump ordered an increased presence of federal law enforcement in the capital in an effort to curb crime. **ANDREW LEYDEN/GETTY**

Trump activates Guard troops in DC

President taking control of capital’s Police Department

By **Josh Boak**
and **David Klepper**
Associated Press

WASHINGTON — President Donald Trump said Monday that he’s taking over Washington’s Police Department and activating 800 members of the National Guard in the hopes of reducing crime, even as city officials emphasized that crime is already falling in the nation’s capital.

The president, flanked by his attorney general, his defense

secretary and the FBI director, said he was declaring a public safety emergency and that his administration would be removing homeless encampments.

“We’re going to take our capital back,” Trump declared, and he’d also be “getting rid of the slums.”

For Trump, the effort to take over public safety in Washington reflects an escalation of his aggressive approach to law enforcement. The District of Columbia’s status as a congressionally established federal district

gives him a unique opportunity to push his tough-on-crime agenda, although he has not proposed solutions to the root causes of homelessness or crime.

Attorney General Pam Bondi will assume responsibility for the Metropolitan Police Department, Trump said as he railed against potholes and graffiti in the city and called them “embarrassing.”

The president did not provide a timeline for the control of the Police Department, but he’s limited to 30 days under stat-

ute unless he gets approval from Congress.

As Trump spoke, demonstrators gathered outside the White House to protest his moves. And local officials rejected the Republican president’s depiction of the district as crime-ridden and called his actions illegal.

“The administration’s actions are unprecedented, unnecessary and unlawful,” District of Columbia Attorney General Brian Schwab said. “There is no crime emergency in the District

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Ex-McCook mayor sentenced to 4 years

Tobolski called ‘Jekyll and Hyde’ by judge in corruption case

By **Jason Meisner**
Chicago Tribune

Jeffrey Tobolski traveled a well-worn path in Chicago-area politics, from following in the footsteps of his late father as mayor of the tiny west suburban town of McCook to double-dipping as a Cook County commissioner.

But his career also had another familiar — and darker — ring to it. For years, federal prosecutors say, he used his positions to create a fiefdom of graft, shaking down business owners who needed liquor licenses, forcing a developer to install air conditioning in his home for free, and even enlisting McCook’s police chief as his personal bagman.

After the FBI raided Tobol-

ski’s offices in the fall of 2019, he became the poster boy in a burgeoning federal corruption probe that eventually brought down nearly a dozen suburban elected officials and political operatives, including Tobolski’s chief of staff and other close associates.

On Monday, nearly six years after Tobolski agreed to cooperate with the investigation, a federal judge sentenced him to four years in prison, calling him “a Jekyll and Hyde human being” who’d clearly become consumed by the power of his position.

“I think that the elixir for you was the power of that office, fueled by alcohol,” U.S. District Chief Judge Virginia Kendall said. “The side that was exhibited during those years was a very ugly, aggressive, arrogant individual, like the complete flip side of a human being.”

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Instructional bilingual teacher assistant Esperanza Baeza does yoga with students in the garden of Grissom Fine and Performing Arts Elementary School in Chicago on July 2. Baeza leads a garden club and encourages students to enjoy the garden. **HAILEY HOFFMAN/FOR THE CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

FROM GRAY TO GREEN

Across Chicago, dozens of concrete schoolyards transformed into community hubs, flood fixes

By **Adriana Pérez**
Chicago Tribune

Scissors in hand, Hispanic moms in the Hegewisch neighborhood sneak into their children’s schoolyard and snip herbs from the garden to season food and put a twist in their mole.

The *verdolaga*, or purslane, is part of a variety of vegetables and plants entrusted to the care of

students and teachers at Grissom Elementary School.

“The neighbors are like, ‘Oh my God, do you mind?’” said Esperanza Baeza, a bilingual teacher assistant at the school. She tells the parents, “This is *our* garden. You take whatever you want.”

A decade ago, Grissom’s schoolyard at 12810 S. Escanaba Ave. was not the vibrant space it now is. The tree-lined streets flanking the

property stood in stark contrast to 2 acres of dull concrete where the children would play during recess.

Now, the school has a native plant garden brimming with tall grass, flowers and butterflies, a new swing set and additional playground equipment, a basketball court, a running track circling a soccer field and an outdoor class area.

“This was just asphalt. There was nothing,” Baeza said. “It was a really old little piece of swing.

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Kifowit joins race for Ill. comptroller

The 12-year state lawmaker from Oswego entered the still-growing field to become the Democratic nominee. **Chicagoland**, Page 3

More Starbucks workers join union

Baristas working at Orland Square voted Aug. 1 to join Starbucks Workers United, a nationwide union of more than 12,000 baristas. **Business**

